AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Bastion

Hardening & Defensive Infrastructure Tools

33	187,517	85%	25
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

Intro: Lock it down before they get in — auditing, hardening and host/network defense tooling.

Deep-research edition. Every entry re-verified and enriched with live GitHub statistics (stars, first release, last push, license, language) pulled 2026-10-17 via the GitHub API, plus per-realm field intelligence. Tool profiles rank the realm's most-adopted projects and note who uses each tool and the commercial product it replaces; the full inventory keeps every curated entry.

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — **444 curated free tools across 14 realms**.

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven
CC0 · 2026-10-17

01 Realm Intelligence

live GitHub census · 2026-10-17

33	28	187,517	25	4,323	2011
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Intro: Lock it down before they get in — auditing, hardening and host/network defense tooling.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE (AI-ASSISTED)

The Bastion realm of hardening and defensive infrastructure tools includes 33 curated entries, with 85% hosted on GitHub and a median star count of 4,323, indicating a mature, well-adopted field with concentrated popularity in top offerings: Fail2ban, Lynis, and CrowdSec lead with 15.2k to 18.8k stars, while the oldest entry dates to 2011, establishing long-term relevance. Maintenance activity shows 25 tools received code pushes in 2026, meaning roughly three-quarters of the curated set remains actively updated, though 8 tools have not seen pushes in the current year, including notable entries GoPhish and OpenRASP. The license mix is heavily weighted toward non-standard or unlisted licenses (11 entries), with MIT, GPL, and Apache-2.0 making up the remaining 22 tools, creating potential compliance considerations for deployments. A key trend is the dominance of C, Go, and Python as primary languages, with 18 of 33 tools built on these three, reflecting a preference for performance, scalability, and ease of scripting in defensive infrastructure tooling.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

01 The Adoption Map

who the community actually stars

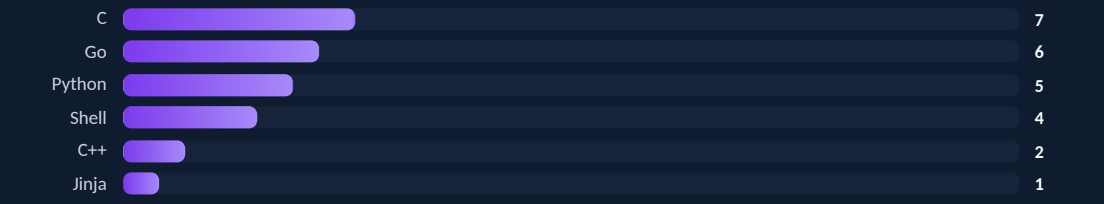
TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST-FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



LANGUAGE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



01 Generations & Momentum

the realm's age structure

THE FOUNDERS — OLDEST TRACKED ENTRIES

Fail2ban	2011-09-28
OpenVPN	2012-04-26
ClamAV	2012-07-20
OSSEC	2013-09-17
GoPhish	2013-11-18

THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST GITHUB ARRIVALS

open-appsec	2022-10
shellfirm	2021-12
Awesome WebSocket Security	2021-11
Fleet	2020-11
Coraza	2020-05

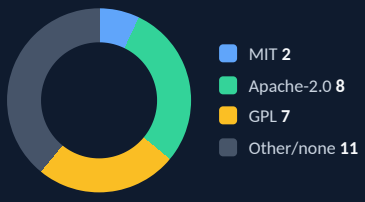
CREATION ERAS — WHEN THE REALM WAS BUILT

2008-2012	2013-2016	2017-2020	2021-2026
3	12	10	3

QUIET CLASSICS (NO 2026 PUSH, STILL THE STANDARD)

OpenRASP, GoPhish, Awesome WebSocket Security

LICENSE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



02 Tool Profiles — the heavyweights

full-page dossiers · ranked by adoption

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, **who uses it and which commercial product it replaces**, and its star weight against the realm's #1.

Profiles are ordered by GitHub adoption (stars). Non-GitHub entries follow, alphabetically. Flagship marks the realm's top 8 by stars.

01 Fail2ban

github.com/fail2ban/fail2ban

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 18.8k	GITHUB STARS
1,508	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2011	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Daemon to ban hosts that cause multiple authentication errors"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic log-watching IPS that bans brute-forcing IPs; still the default answer on every Linux server.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by sysadmins on millions of servers to stop brute force; the classic free guard no commercial tool needed to replace.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



15	1,508	279	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

02 Lynis

github.com/CISOfy/lynis

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 16.5k	GITHUB STARS
1,638	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Shell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Lynis - Security auditing tool for Linux, macOS, and UNIX-based systems. Assists with compliance testing (HIPAA/ISO27001/PCI DSS) and system hardening. Agentless, and installation optional."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

agentless system auditing and hardening with CIS/PCI-DSS-aligned findings; runs anywhere in minutes.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by system auditors running CIS-style hardening checks; the open-source alternative to commercial compliance scanners for Linux/Unix hosts.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



13	1,638	224	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

03 CrowdSec

github.com/crowdsecurity/crowdsec

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 15.2k	GITHUB STARS
742	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Open-source IDS/IPS, WAF and bot detection for Linux, Windows, Docker and Kubernetes, with a crowdsourced blocklist of malicious IPs."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

collaborative behavior-detection engine with a global IP-reputation network; the modern Fail2ban, 60x faster and IPv6-ready.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by server administrators and hosting providers; the open-source, crowdsourced alternative to commercial WAF and bot-management services.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



6	742	301	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

04 OpenVPN

github.com/OpenVPN/openvpn

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 14.7k	GITHUB STARS
3,415	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OpenVPN is an open source VPN daemon"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the industry-standard open-source VPN daemon for site-to-site and remote-access tunnels.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by IT teams everywhere; the open-source alternative to commercial VPN gateways.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



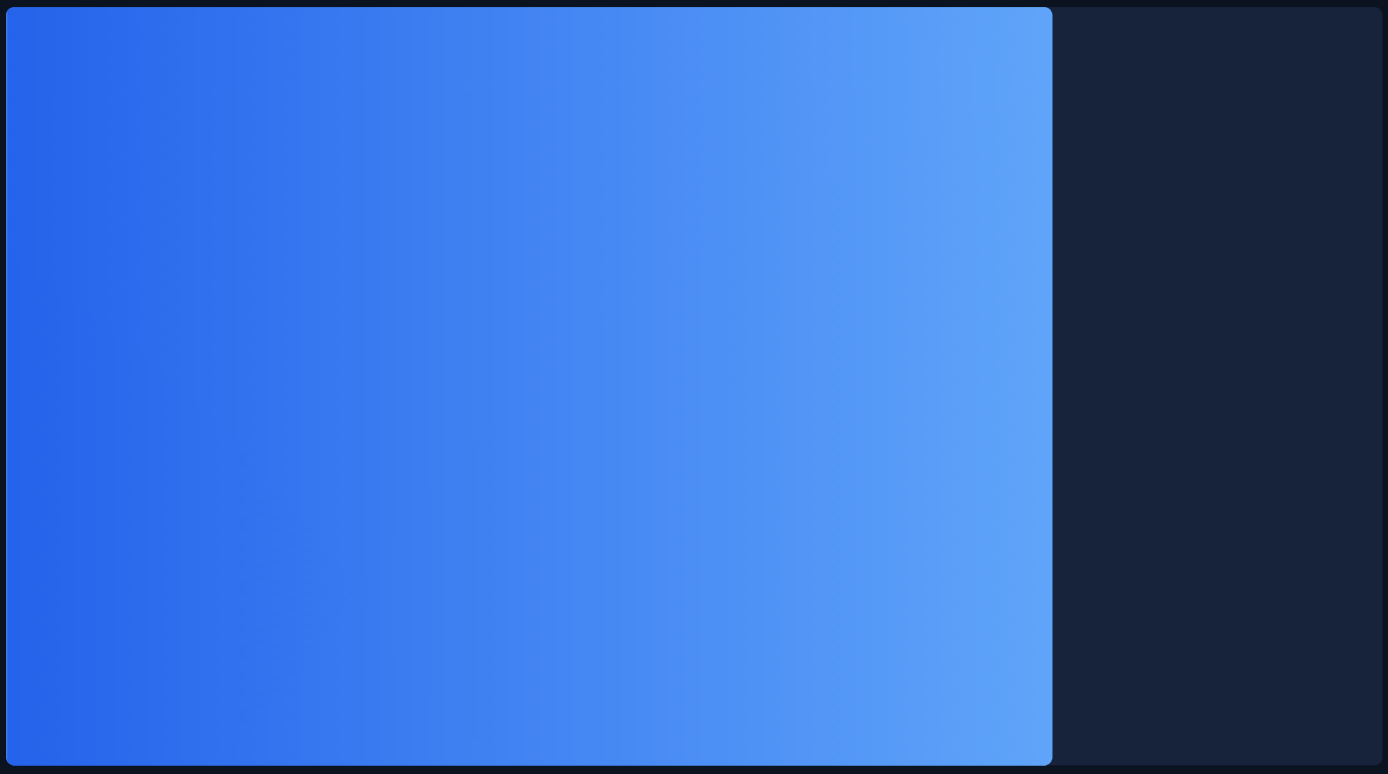
14	3,415	223	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

05 GoPhish

github.com/gophish/gophish

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

star weight vs realm #1



★ 14.3k	GITHUB STARS
2,984	FORKS
2024-09	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Open-Source Phishing Toolkit"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open-source phishing-simulation platform: launch awareness campaigns and measure exactly who clicks (community edition).

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by security awareness teams running phishing simulations; the open-source alternative to commercial awareness platforms like KnowBe4.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



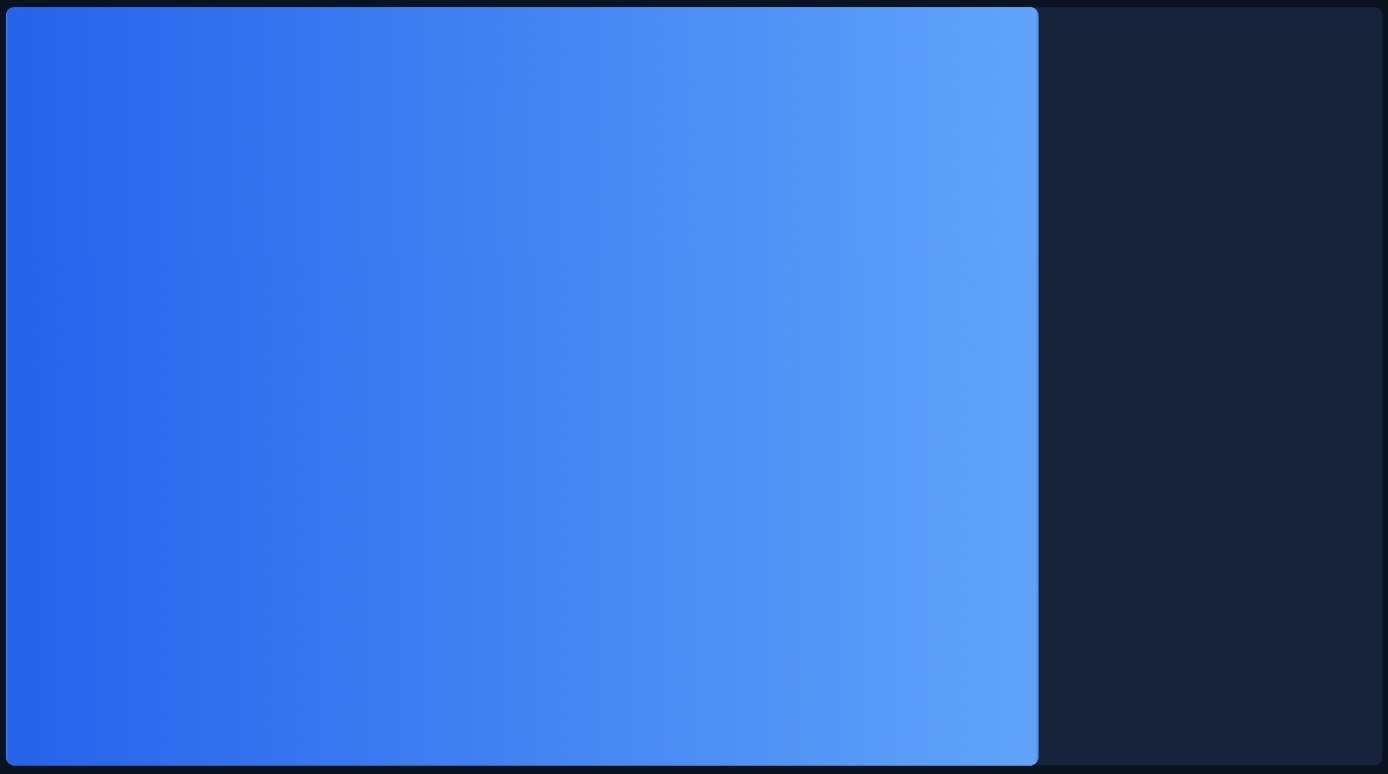
13	2,984	763	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

06 OpenSnitch

github.com/evilsocket/opensnitch

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 14.2k	GITHUB STARS
677	FORKS
2026-07	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OpenSnitch is a GNU/Linux interactive application firewall inspired by Little Snitch."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

interactive application firewall (Little Snitch for Linux): allow/deny every outbound connection per process.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by Linux power users and admins wanting per-application firewall control; the open equivalent of Little Snitch on macOS.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



9	677	209	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

07 Vuls

github.com/future-architect/vuls

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 12.3k	GITHUB STARS
1,248	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Agent-less vulnerability scanner for Linux, FreeBSD, Container, WordPress, Programming language libraries, Network devices"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

agentless vulnerability scanner for servers and containers, with CVE reporting across Linux and FreeBSD fleets.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by server admins for agentless vulnerability scanning; the open-source alternative to Nessus for host patch audits.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



10	1,248	94	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

08 BunkerWeb

github.com/bunkerity/bunkerweb

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 11.1k	GITHUB STARS
653	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
AGPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“🛡️ Open-source and cloud-native Web Application Firewall (WAF)”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

next-gen open WAF built on nginx: HTTPS, bot mitigation and network protections on by default.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by web admins wanting a next-gen open-source WAF in front of their sites; the self-hosted alternative to Cloudflare's managed WAF.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



7 YEARS ON GITHUB	653 FORKS (REUSE)	161 OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

09 testssl.sh

github.com/drwetter/testssl.sh

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 9.2k	GITHUB STARS
1,152	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Shell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Testing TLS/SSL encryption anywhere on any port"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

command-line TLS/SSL configuration auditor: protocols, ciphers, chains, vulnerabilities, grading — no agent required.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by TLS auditors and pentesters everywhere; the free command-line alternative to Qualys SSL Labs for server-side TLS grading.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



12	1,152	252	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

10 ClamAV

github.com/Cisco-Talos/clamav

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 7.4k	GITHUB STARS
936	FORKS
2026-08	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“ClamAV - Documentation is here: https://docs.clamav.net”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the open-source antivirus engine that powers mail gateways and file-screening pipelines everywhere. Used on countless mail gateways and Linux file screens; the AV engine many commercial mail filters embed.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



14	936	413	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

11 Fleet

github.com/fleetdm/fleet

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 7k	GITHUB STARS
1,067	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Open device management"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

osquery fleet management: device visibility and policy enforcement at scale, open core with a free tier.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by IT and security teams managing osquery fleets at scale; the open-source alternative to commercial device management and EDR consoles.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



6	1,067	3,857	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

12 dev-sec hardening collection

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/dev-sec/ansible-collection-hardening

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.5k	GITHUB STARS
839	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Jinja	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"This Ansible collection provides battle tested hardening for Linux, SSH, nginx, MySQL"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

battle-tested Ansible roles for OS, SSH, nginx and MySQL baselines; hardening as code.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by DevOps teams enforcing server baselines as code; the open-source alternative to commercial configuration-compliance agents.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11	839	93	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

13 OSSEC

github.com/ossec/ossec-hids

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.1k	GITHUB STARS
1,076	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OSSEC is an Open Source Host-based Intrusion Detection System that performs log analysis, file integrity checking, policy monitoring, rootkit detection, real-time alerting and active response."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the original open-source HIDS: log analysis, file integrity and rootkit detection (Wazuh's ancestor).

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by SOC teams on a budget for host intrusion detection; the veteran open HIDS that predates commercial EDR.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



13 YEARS ON GITHUB	1,076 FORKS (REUSE)	40 OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

14 OPNsense

github.com/opnsense/core

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.7k	GITHUB STARS
1,009	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
BSD-2-Clause	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OPNsense GUI, API and systems backend"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open-source firewall/router distro with IDS, VPN and reporting — a pfSense successor built on HardenedBSD.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by network administrators as a full open-source firewall/router; the business-ready free alternative to commercial UTM appliances.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



12	1,009	309	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

15 ssh-audit

github.com/jtesta/ssh-audit

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.3k	GITHUB STARS
234	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"SSH server & client security auditing (banner, key exchange, encryption, mac, compression, compatibility, security, etc)"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

SSH server configuration auditor: algorithms, keys and best-practice flags in one run.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by server hardening teams to audit SSH configurations and algorithms; the standard free SSH auditor.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



9	234	46	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

16 OpenSSH

github.com/openssh/openssh-portable

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4k	GITHUB STARS
2,189	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Portable OpenSSH”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the world's default secure remote-access suite: encrypted shells, tunnels and key management. Used on virtually every Linux server on earth; the open standard for secure remote access that commercial SSH servers complement, not replace. (BSD-style)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



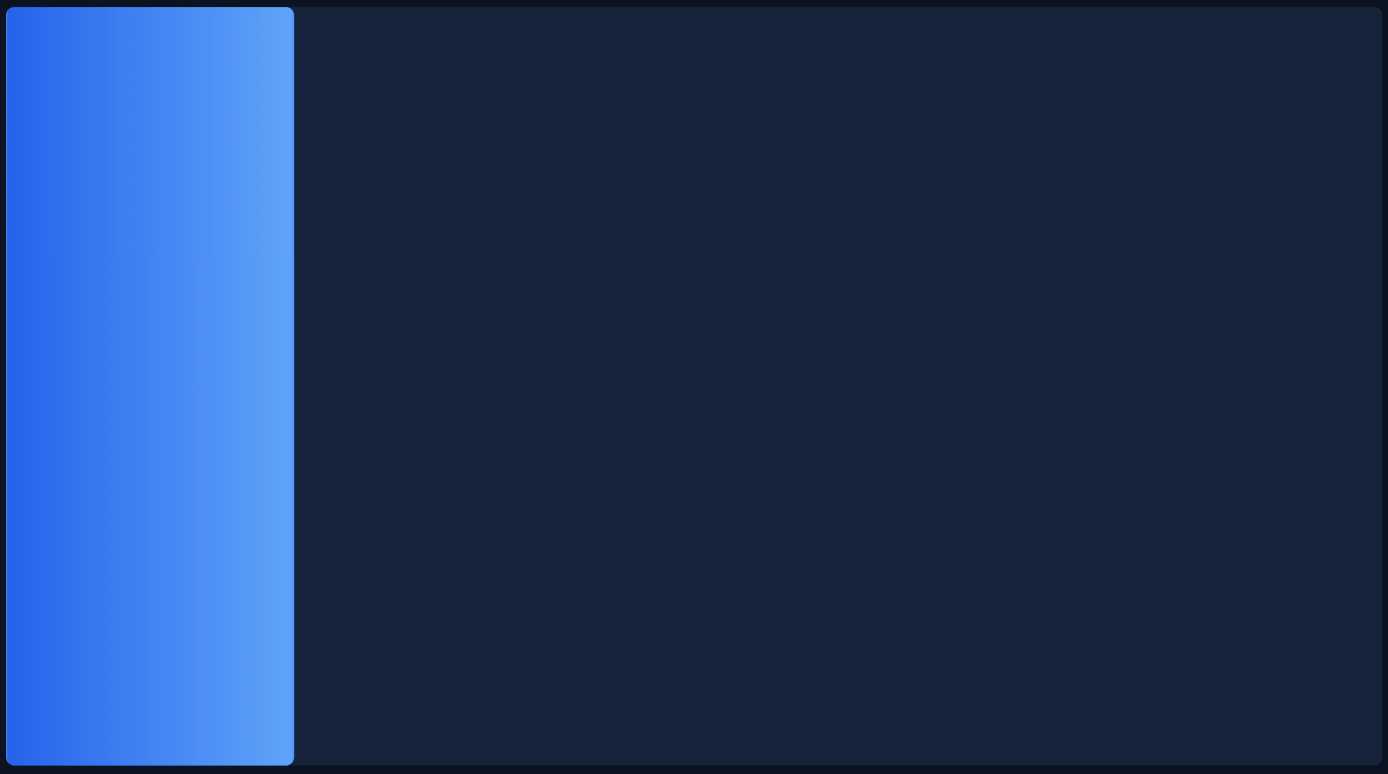
12	2,189	143	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

17 Coraza

github.com/corazawaf/coraza

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.9k	GITHUB STARS
368	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OWASP Coraza WAF is a golang modsecurity compatible web application firewall library"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

ModSecurity-compatible WAF engine in Go; the actively developed successor for OWASP CRS deployments.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by platform teams embedding a WAF engine inside Go services.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



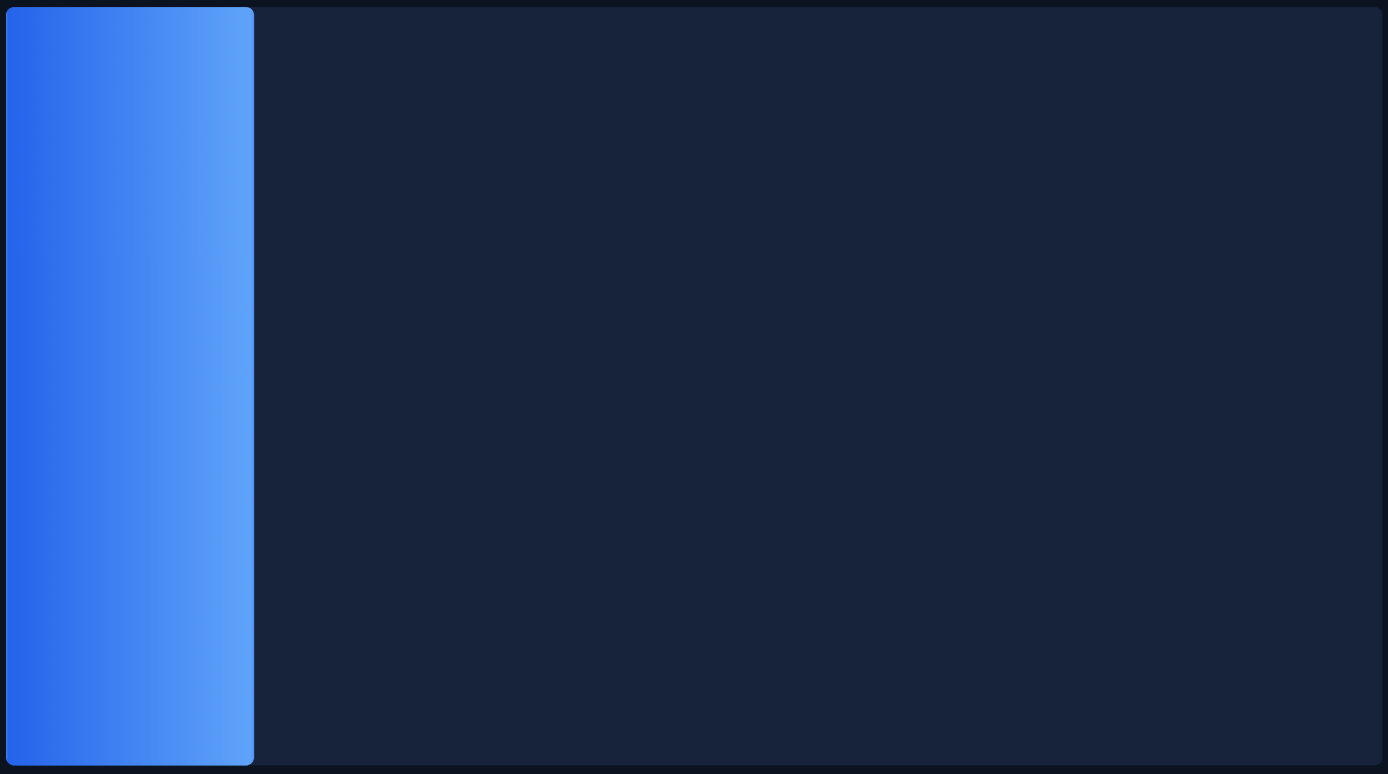
6	368	98	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

18 OWASP Core Rule Set

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/coreruleset/coreruleset

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.3k	GITHUB STARS
471	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OWASP CRS (Official Repository)"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the world's most-deployed WAF ruleset; battle-tested protection for web servers, tuned for ModSecurity and Coraza.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by WAF administrators on nginx, Apache and Coraza; the free ruleset protecting more sites than most commercial WAF feeds.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

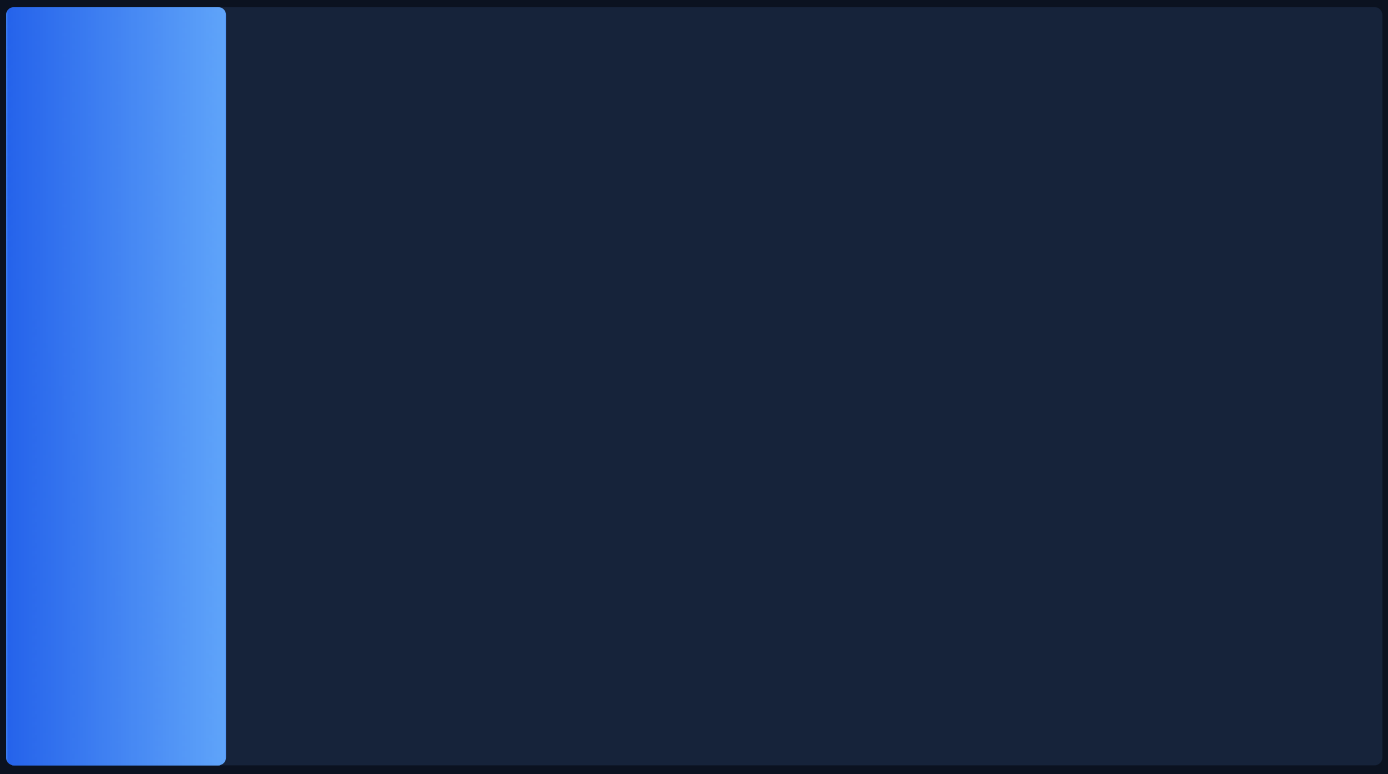


6	471	118	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

19 OpenRASP

github.com/baidu/openrasp

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3k	GITHUB STARS
622	FORKS
2025-10	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
C++	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"🔥Open source RASP solution"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

runtime application self-protection: instrument the app itself so attacks get blocked from the inside.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by AppSec teams adding runtime self-protection to apps; the open-source alternative to commercial RASP vendors.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



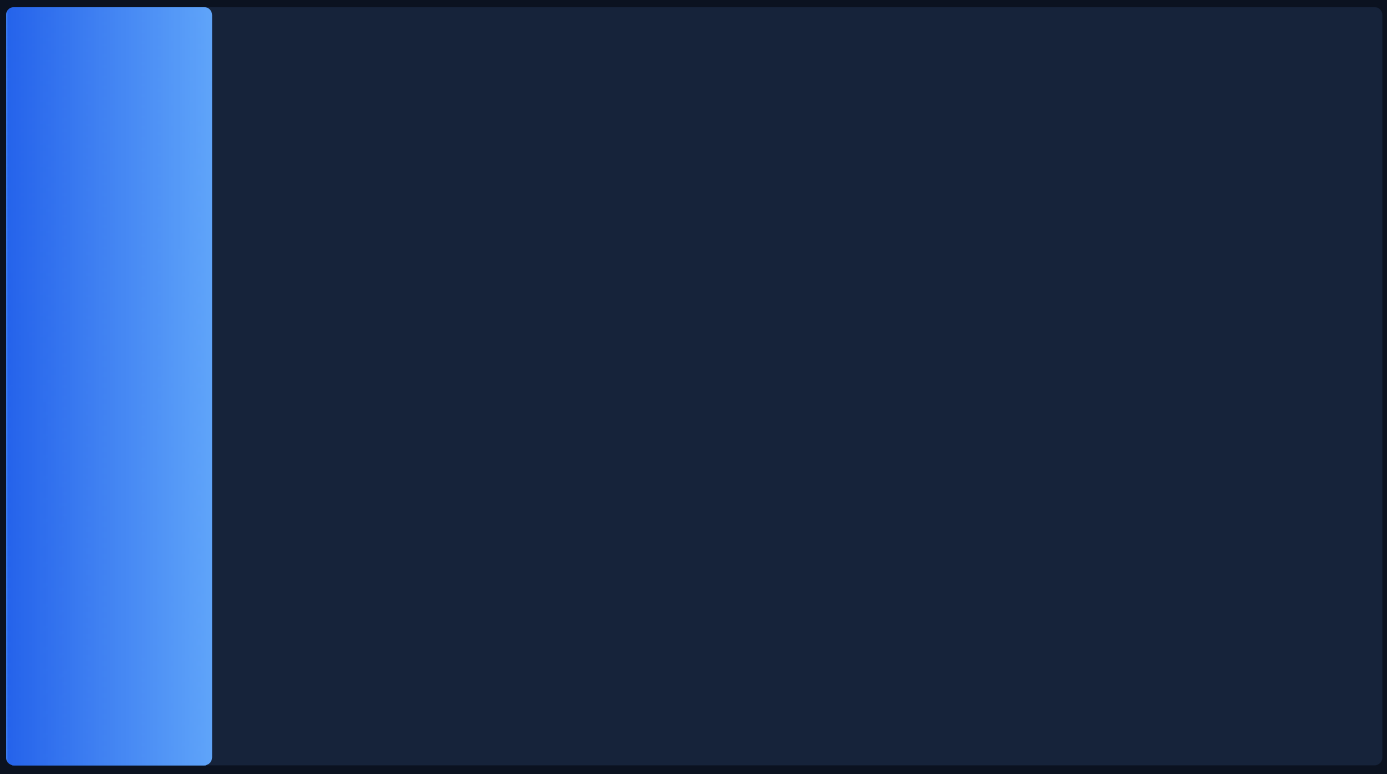
9	622	62	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

20 ComplianceAsCode content

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/ComplianceAsCode/content

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.8k	GITHUB STARS
843	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Shell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Security automation content in SCAP, Bash, Ansible, and other formats"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the open SCAP/Baseline rule corpus for RHEL, Ubuntu and friends; the content that powers OpenSCAP-style audits.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by compliance and platform teams applying SCAP hardening profiles; the open-source ruleset commercial compliance products build on.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



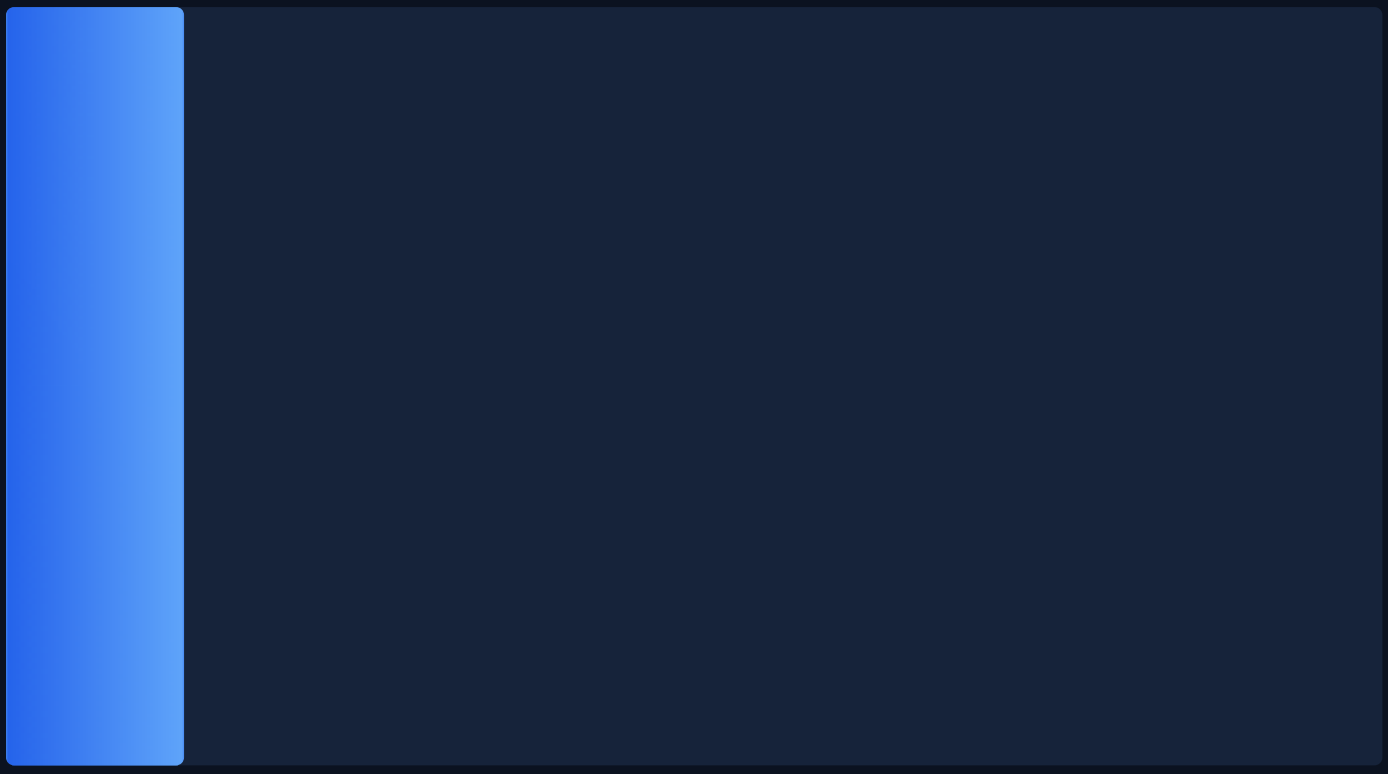
12	843	235	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

21 checksec.sh

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/slimm609/checksec.sh

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.4k	GITHUB STARS
316	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Checksec"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

one-shot binary hardening audit: NX, canaries, PIE, RELRO and fortify flags in a single run.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by exploit developers and binary auditors checking hardening mitigations; the standard free one-liner for this job.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



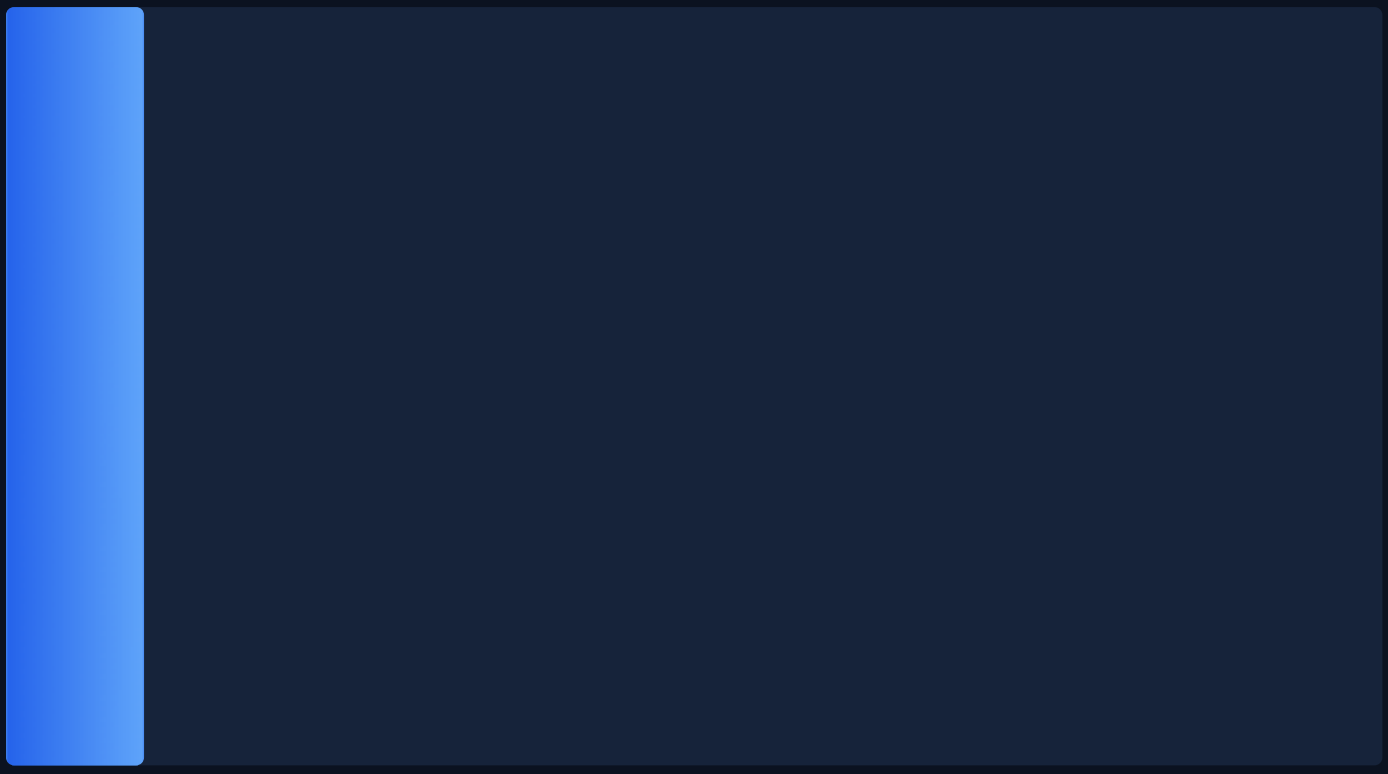
12	316	4	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

22 Neo23x0 auditd config

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/Neo23x0/auditd

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2k	GITHUB STARS
311	FORKS
2026-05	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Shell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Best Practice Auditd Configuration"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Florian Roth's hardened auditd rule set: the Linux logging baseline used across incident-response teams.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by blue teams hardening Linux audit collection; the widely-forked open auditd baseline behind many SOC deployments.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



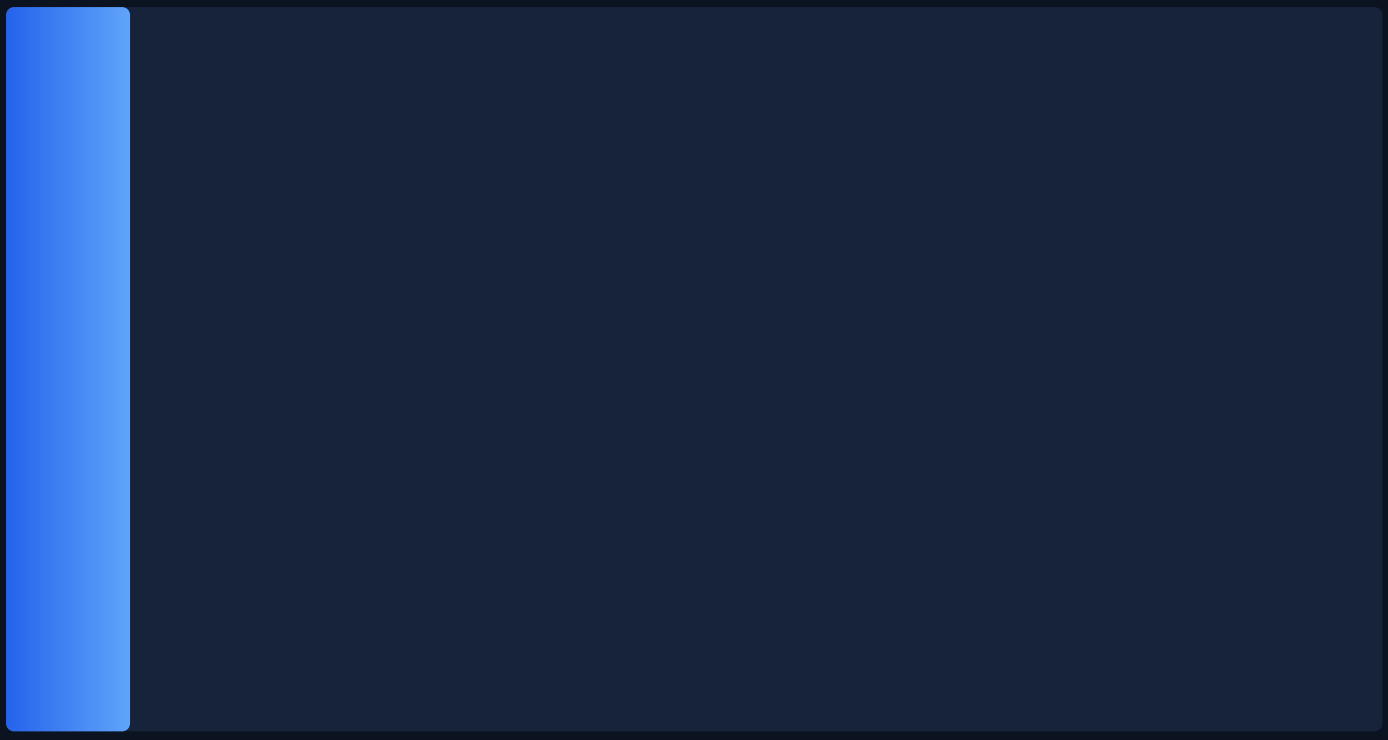
8	311	19	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

23 open-appsec

github.com/openappsec/openappsec

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.7k	GITHUB STARS
138	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2022	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
C++	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"open-appsec is a machine learning security engine that preemptively and automatically prevents threats against Web Application & APIs. This repo include the main code and logic."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

ML-driven prevention engine that stops OWASP Top 10 and zero-day web attacks without signatures.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by security teams deploying machine-learning WAF protection; an open-source alternative to commercial ML-based WAF products.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



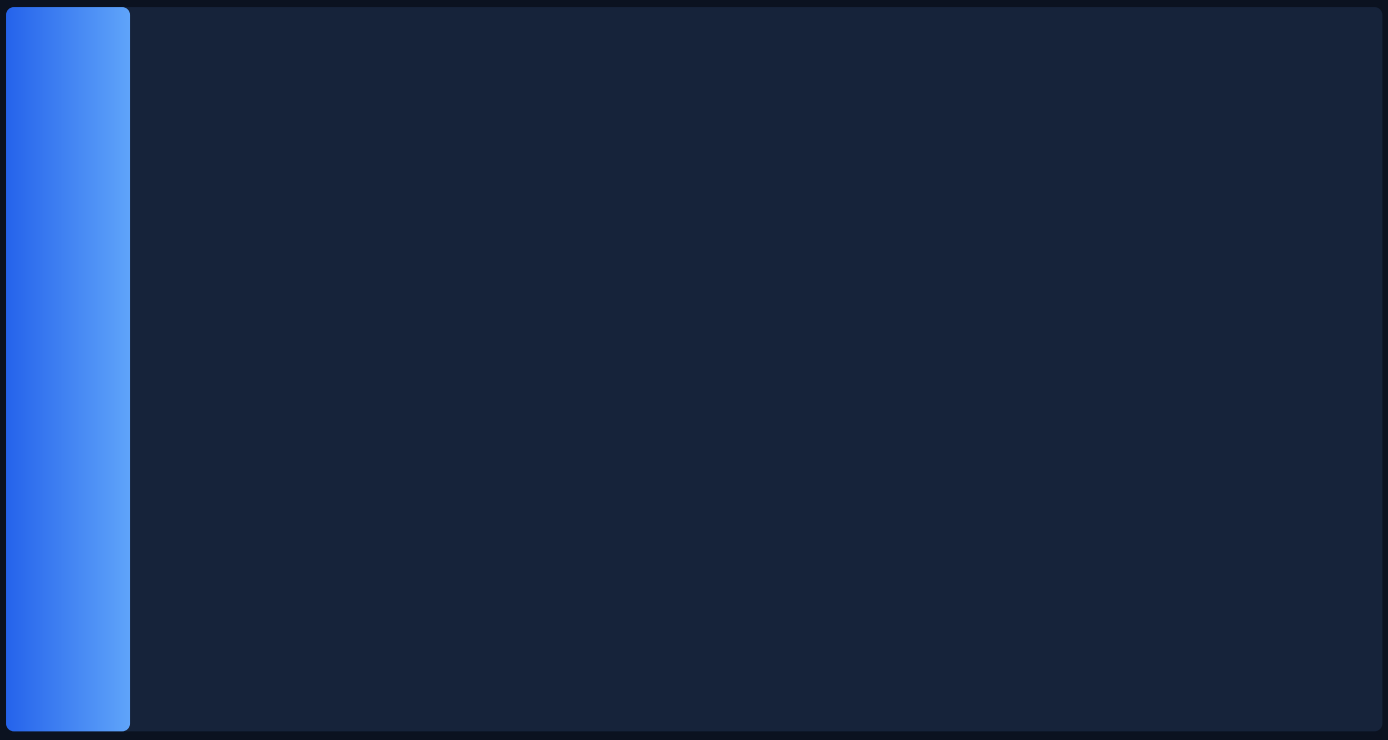
4	138	39	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

24 SELinux

github.com/SELinuxProject/selinux

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.6k	GITHUB STARS
412	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“This is the upstream repository for the Security Enhanced Linux (SELinux) userland libraries and tools. The software provided by this project complements the SELinux features integrated into the Linux kernel and is used ”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

mandatory access control for Linux: policy-based confinement that survives a compromised application.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by hardened enterprise Linux deployments; the mandatory access control standard in RHEL-family distributions.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



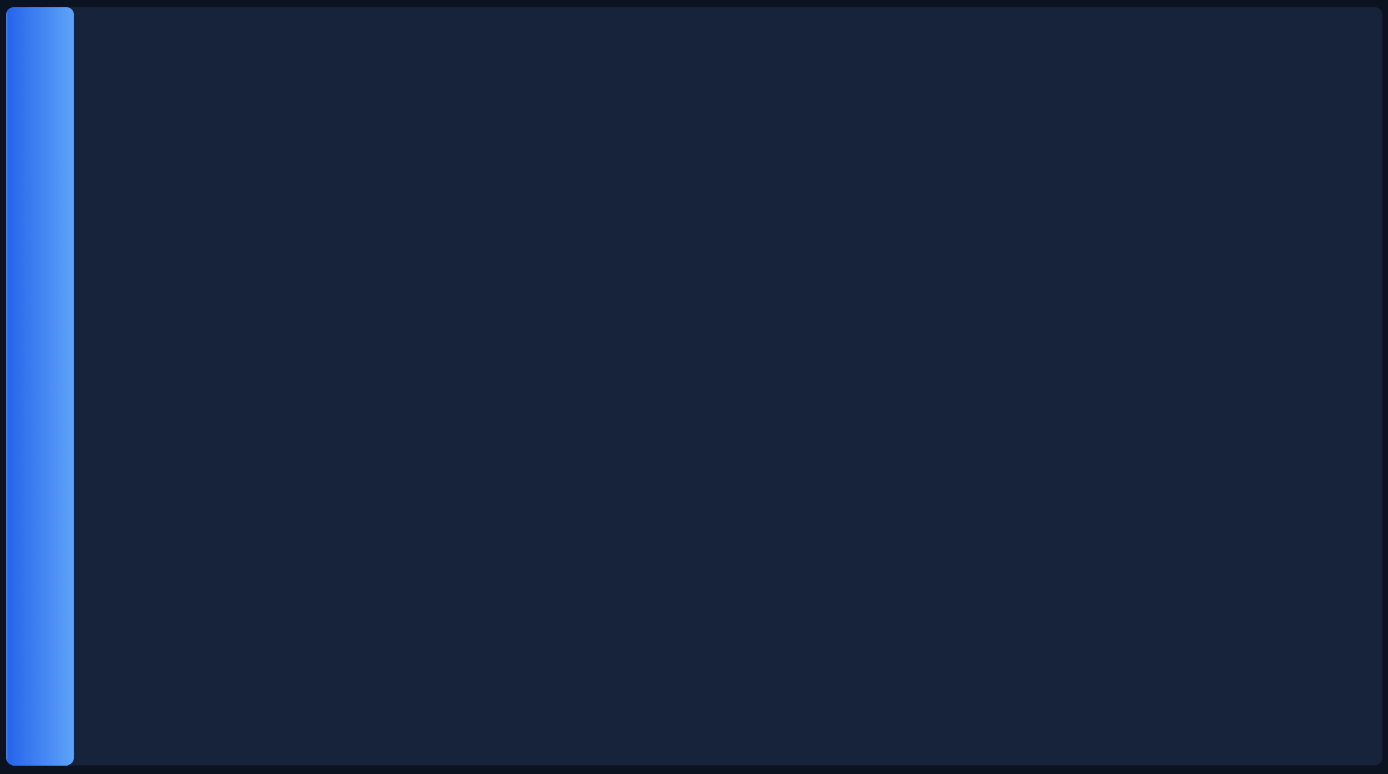
12	412	10	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

25 shellfirm

github.com/kaplanelad/shellfirm

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 946	GITHUB STARS
33	FORKS
2026-05	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Rust	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Safety guardrails for ai coding agents and human terminal commands"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

a pre-execution guard for your shell: challenges dangerous commands (rm -rf, kubectl delete) before they run.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by engineers protecting themselves from dangerous commands; a lightweight open guardrail before your shell executes rm -rf.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



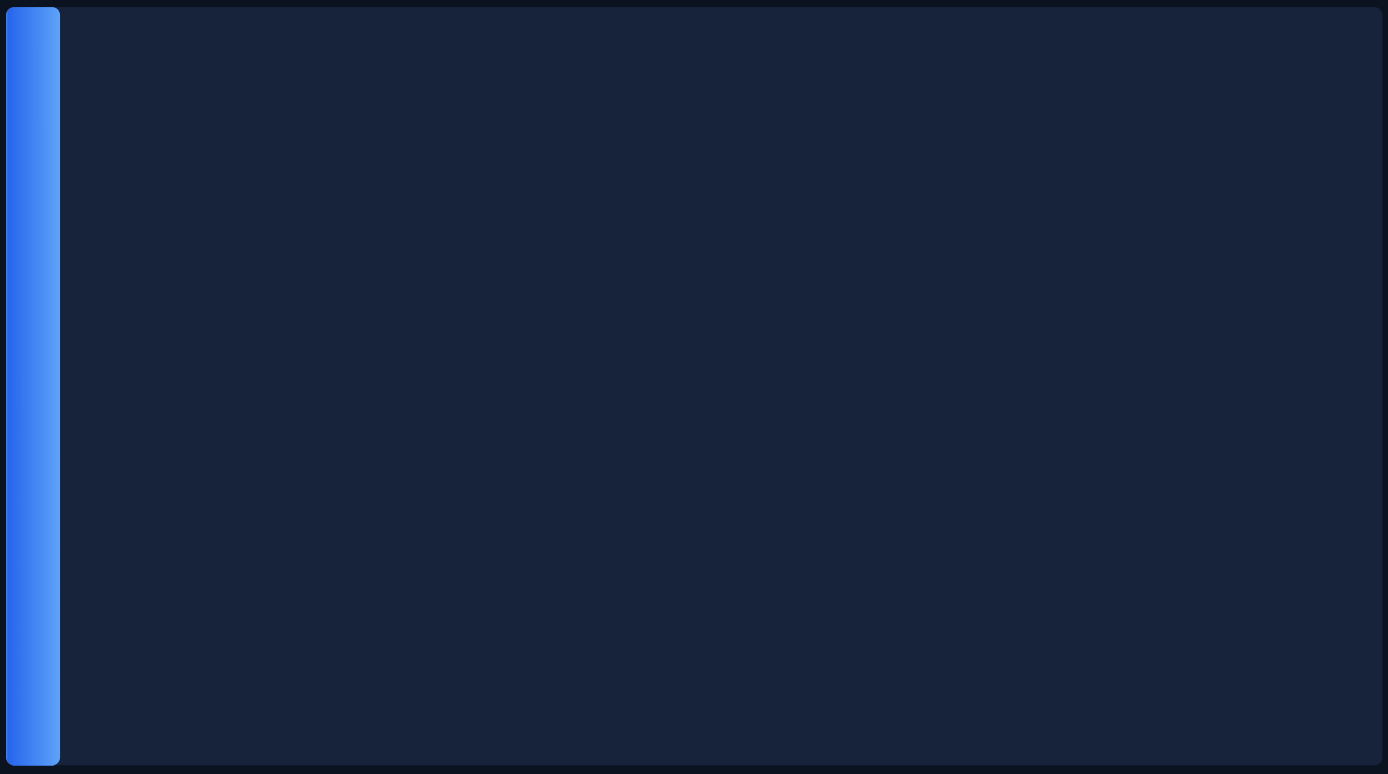
5	33	3	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

26 AIDE

github.com/aide/aide

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 754	GITHUB STARS
118	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"aide source code"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Advanced Intrusion Detection Environment: file-integrity monitoring that alerts the moment system files change.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by hardening teams for file-integrity monitoring; the free open alternative to commercial FIM modules.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



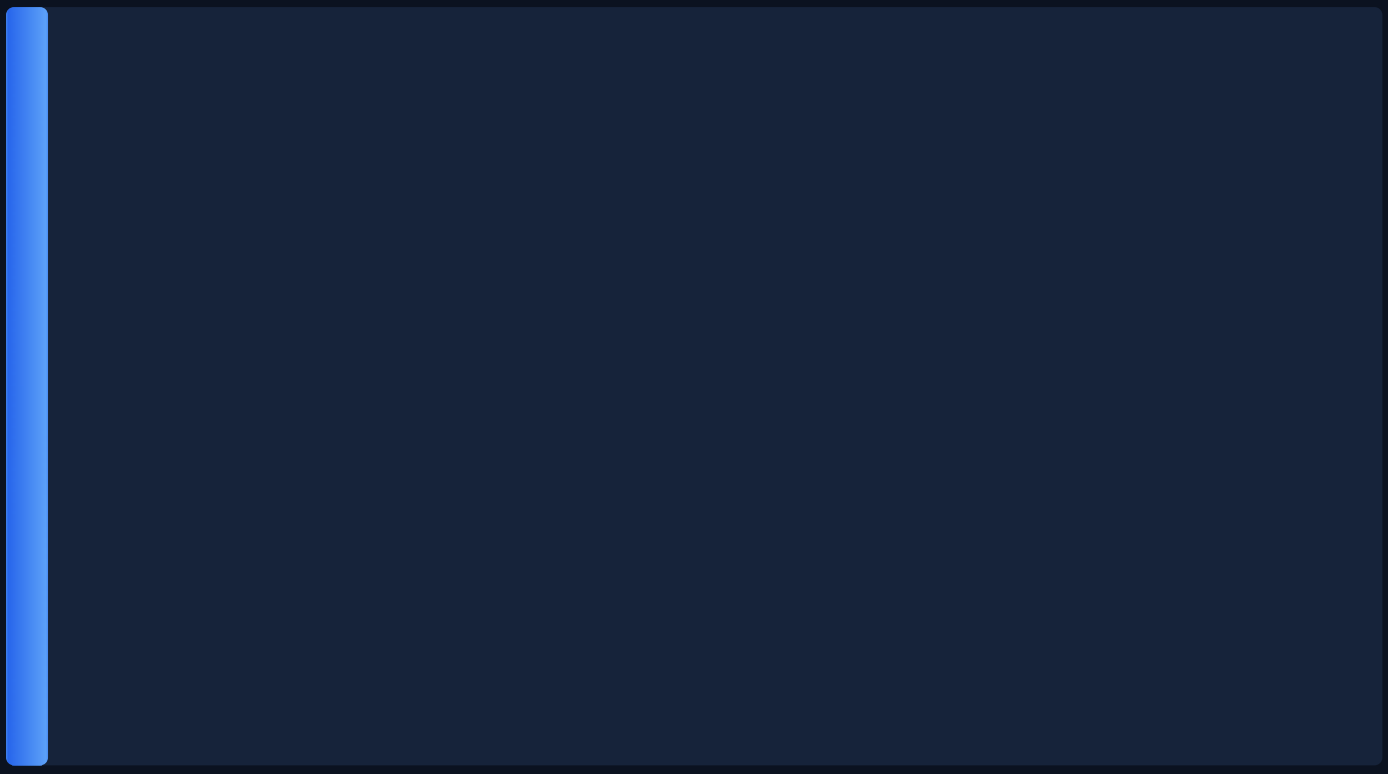
7	118	24	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

27 stunnel

github.com/mtrojnar/stunnel

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 397	GITHUB STARS
94	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

*"Public repository based on official releases. This repository is *not* used for active development. Do *not* submit pull requests."*

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

universal TLS wrapper that adds encryption to any TCP service in minutes.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by admins adding TLS to legacy services; the free universal TLS wrapper.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

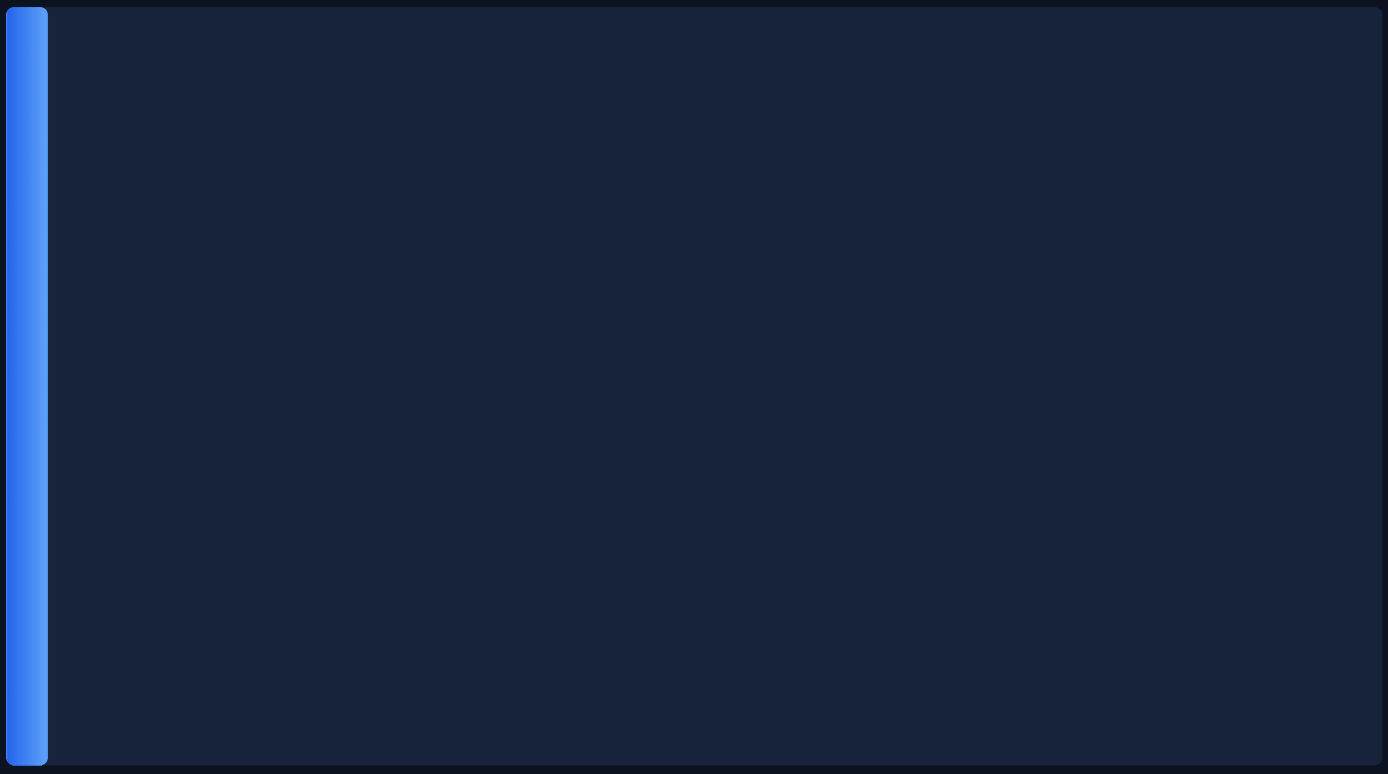


11	94	4	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

28 Awesome WebSocket Security

github.com/PalindromeLabs/awesome-websocket-security

star weight vs realm #1



★ 315	GITHUB STARS
34	FORKS
2022-01	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
—	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Awesome information for WebSockets security research"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

curated research, tools and CVEs for WebSocket protocol security.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by web pentesters studying WebSocket attack surface.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



5	34	0	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

29 Netfilter/iptables

netfilter.org/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Netfilter/iptables"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Linux kernel's native packet-filtering framework; the foundation every host firewall build starts from.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by every Linux firewall admin; the kernel-level packet filter that commercial Linux firewalls wrap a UI around.

30 OpenBSD PF

www.openbsd.org/faq/pf/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OpenBSD PF"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the packet filter famous for correctness and readable rules; the syntax OpenBSD, pfSense and OPNsense share.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by OpenBSD and firewall admins; the famously audited packet filter behind many security appliances.

31 Qubes OS

www.qubes-os.org/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Qubes OS"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the security-by-compartmentalization desktop OS; " reasonably secure" by architecture, not by antivirus.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by journalists, researchers and high-risk users; the compartmentalized security desktop with no commercial counterpart.

32 SpamAssassin

spamassassin.apache.org/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"SpamAssassin"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the veteran open-source spam filter; bayesian scoring and rule engine at the mail gateway.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by mail administrators on countless gateways; the veteran open-source anti-spam engine many commercial filters license.

33 Tor

www.torproject.org/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Tor"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the anonymity network: routed egress through thousands of volunteer relays; the standard for privacy-preserving research access.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by privacy-focused researchers, journalists and investigators; the free anonymity network with no commercial equivalent.

04 Realm Directory

33 curated entries · A–Z

AIDE
Awesome WebSocket Security
BunkerWeb
checksec.sh
ClamAV
ComplianceAsCode content
Coraza
CrowdSec
dev-sec hardening collection
Fail2ban
Fleet
GoPhish
Lynis
Neo23x0 auditd config
Netfilter/iptables
open-appsec
OpenBSD PF
OpenRASP
OpenSnitch
OpenSSH
OpenVPN
OPNsense
OSSEC
OWASP Core Rule Set
Qubes OS
SELinux
shellfirm
SpamAssassin
ssh-audit
stunnel
testssl.sh
Tor
Vuls